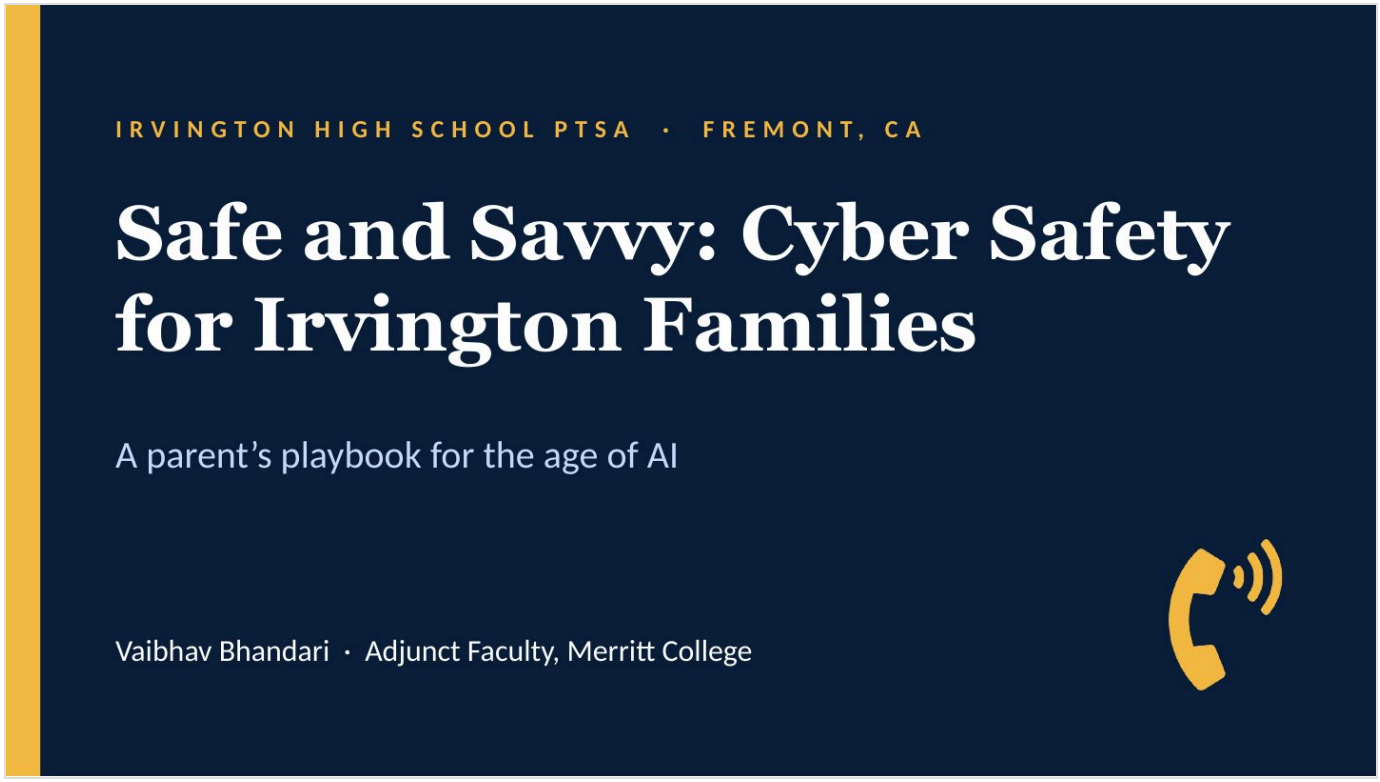
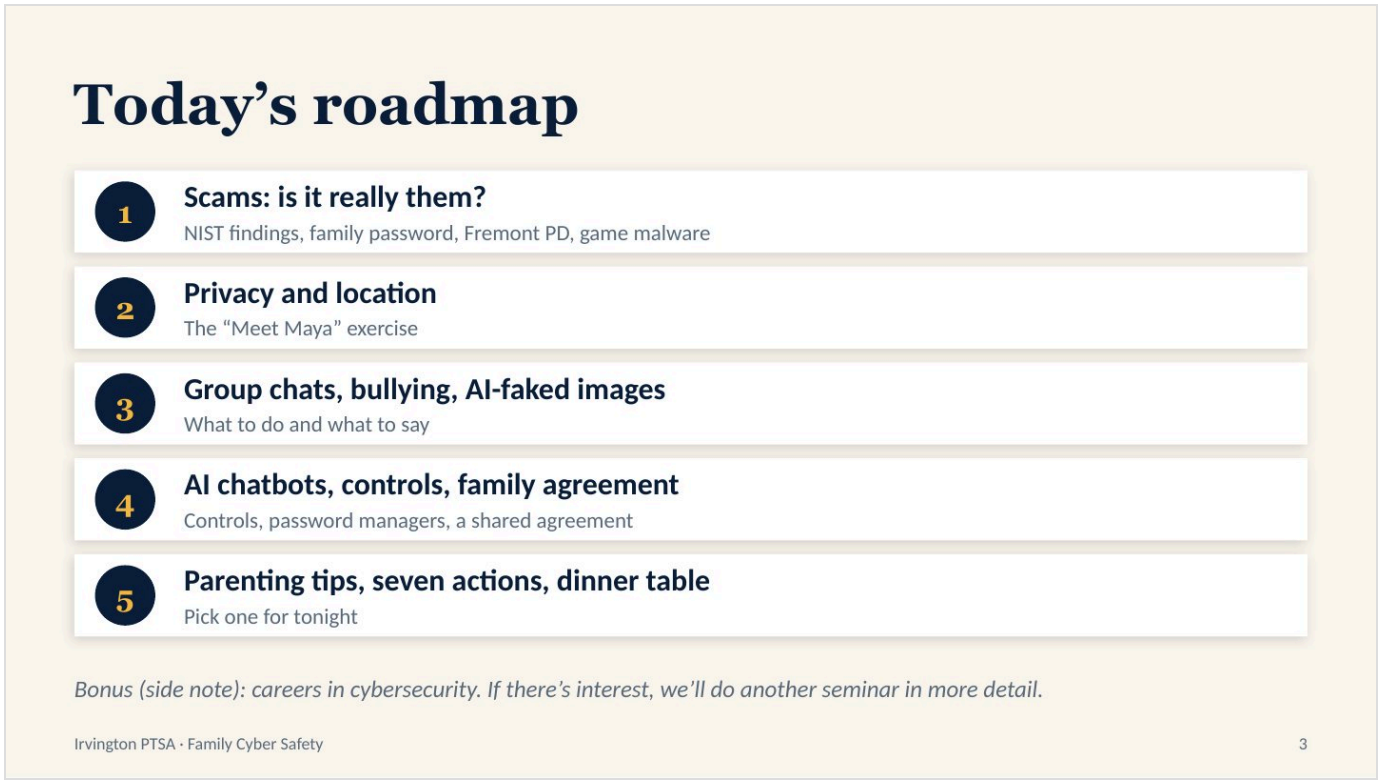


Welcome. This is an online Zoom meeting, so say how to take part: Zoom reactions (thumbs up) for show-of-hands moments, the chat for votes and short exercises, and the chat or Q&A for questions. Tonight is practical: you will leave with one concrete thing to do at the dinner table. Set the tone: no fear-mongering, no tech jargon.



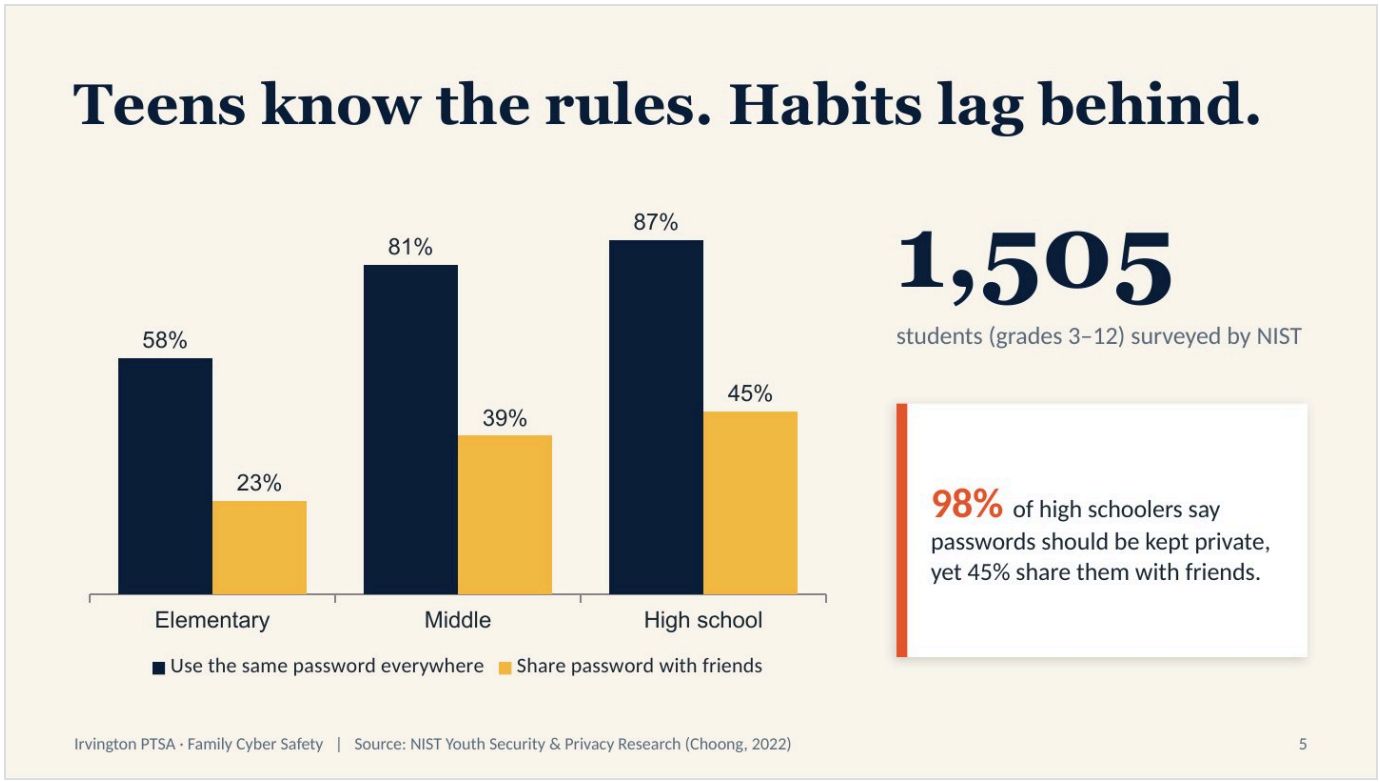
Keep to about 60 seconds. Credentials are from vitraag.com/#about; the current title is shown as Security Engineer at your request. The supporting line under it (building products for funded startups, maker and cyclist) is from the site. Suggested personal hook (add your own): why you care as a parent and community member in Fremont.



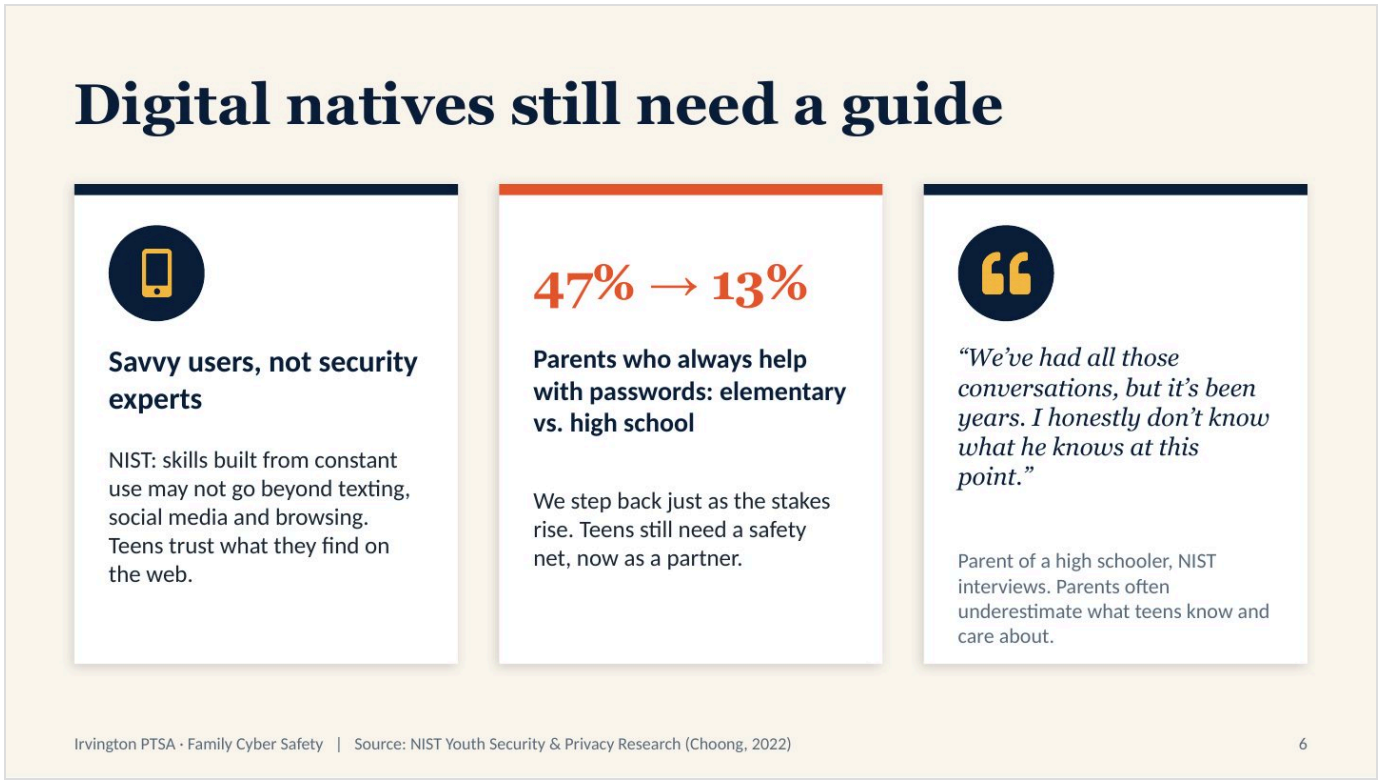
Walk the five blocks in one breath, and mention the interactive moments (Zoom reactions, chat votes, chat challenges, one action for tonight). Careers are a bonus side note in the backup slides, to be used if there is time or interest. If there is interest, offer a longer follow-up seminar.



Read each prompt, pause for Zoom reactions (thumbs up), quick comment (“you are in good company”). The NIST study found most parents reuse passwords too, so this is a no-shame room. Prompt 3 sets up the Roblox/game-malware story later; prompt 2 sets up the AI voice-scam story.



Key message: kids understand the idea; behavior drifts as they get older and friends matter more. That is normal, which is why a family system beats a lecture. Bar values are from the NIST NRC HACK 2022 slides; values are from slide 11 of that deck (Password Practice: the Good and Bad).



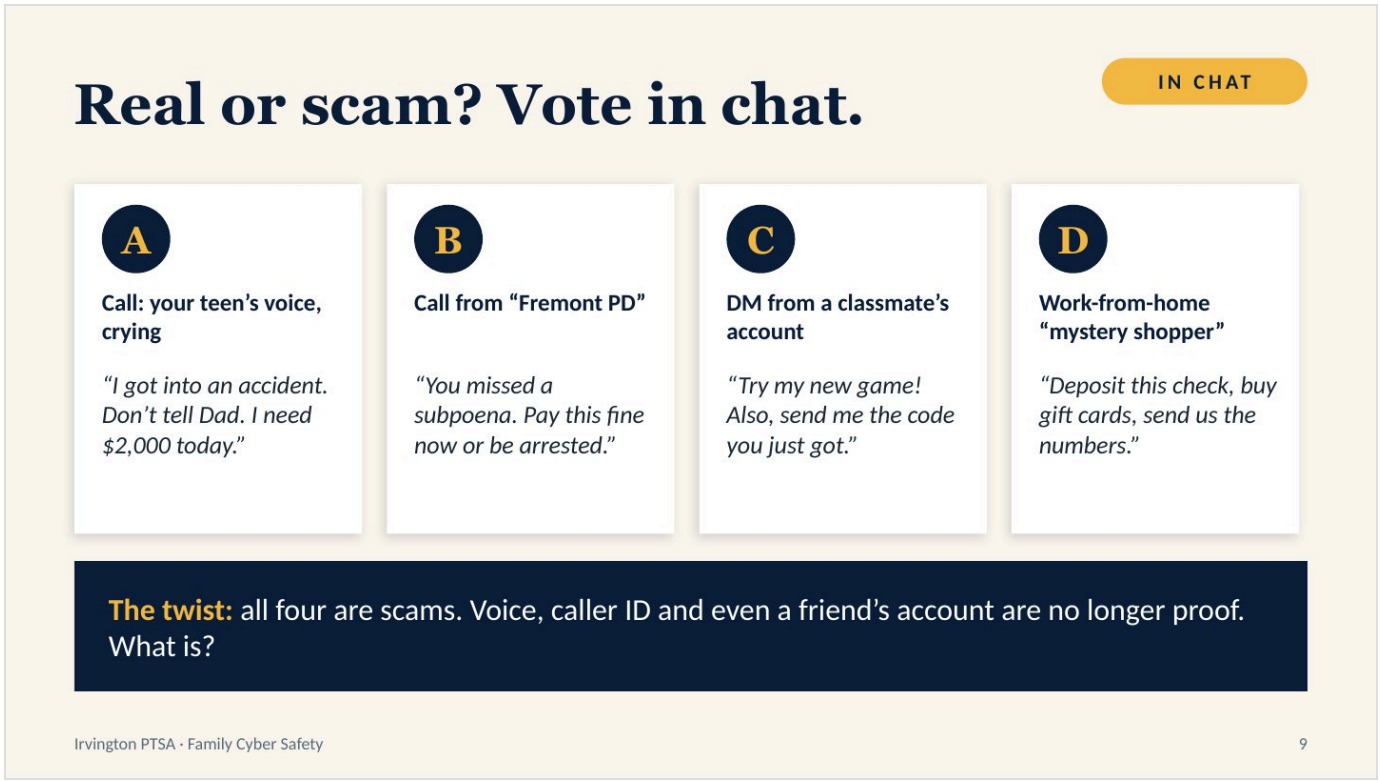
Three NIST findings. (1) Digital natives are heavy users, but NIST found their skills may not extend beyond basics. (2) In the parent survey, 47% of parents of elementary kids always help with password creation vs 13% for high schoolers. (3) In 40 parent/child interviews, parents often underestimated what their kids knew. Bridge: kids are more capable than we think, and more exposed than we think.



Tell a short story: a parent gets a call in their child's voice. Scammers need only a few seconds of audio from a public video, story or game stream. The right-hand red flag is from Fremont PD: neither the department nor any US government agency will call and demand money immediately for the safety of a family member. The next slide goes deeper on what Fremont PD tells residents.



All four cards come from fremontpolice.gov/crime-prevention/scams-fraud-financial-crimes. (1) Fremont PD warns that criminals fake caller ID, including the non-emergency line (510) 790-6800; officers never call from it to request information or solicit money; if you get such a call, hang up. They may also use a real officer's name and claim a missed subpoena, a ticket fine or a tax payment. (2) Neither Fremont PD nor any US government agency will call and demand you send money immediately for the safety of a family member or yourself; call family members first and confirm they are OK; the scammer wants you to react out of emotion. (3) Disturbing-image texts that include a name, address or phone number: that information is generally public or from data breaches; truly specific details (the time you leave for work, a regular sports event) would imply someone is watching. (4) Work-at-home mystery-shopper scams: an official-looking check, instructions to buy gift cards and read out the PIN numbers; the check bounces and the victim loses thousands. Ask for Zoom reactions: who has had a call or text like this? Teen-specific guidance on bullying and AI-faked images comes from ConnectSafely and NCMEC.



Read each scenario aloud (play A in a worried voice). Ask for A, B, C or D in the chat for each (or launch a Zoom poll if enabled), then reveal: all four are scams. A = AI voice clone. B = Fremont PD documents spoofed caller ID that can even show the department's own non-emergency number, with claims of a missed subpoena or ticket fine. C = a familiar account that has been taken over; a login code is the key to the account, so never read one out, even to a friend (Discord's own security page documents malicious downloads, QR codes promising free Nitro and look-alike login sites; it does not specifically cover hijacked friend accounts, so present C as general account-takeover advice). D = the fake-check job scam documented by Fremont PD and the FTC: never pay anyone to get a job. Segue: what is real proof? Something only your family knows.



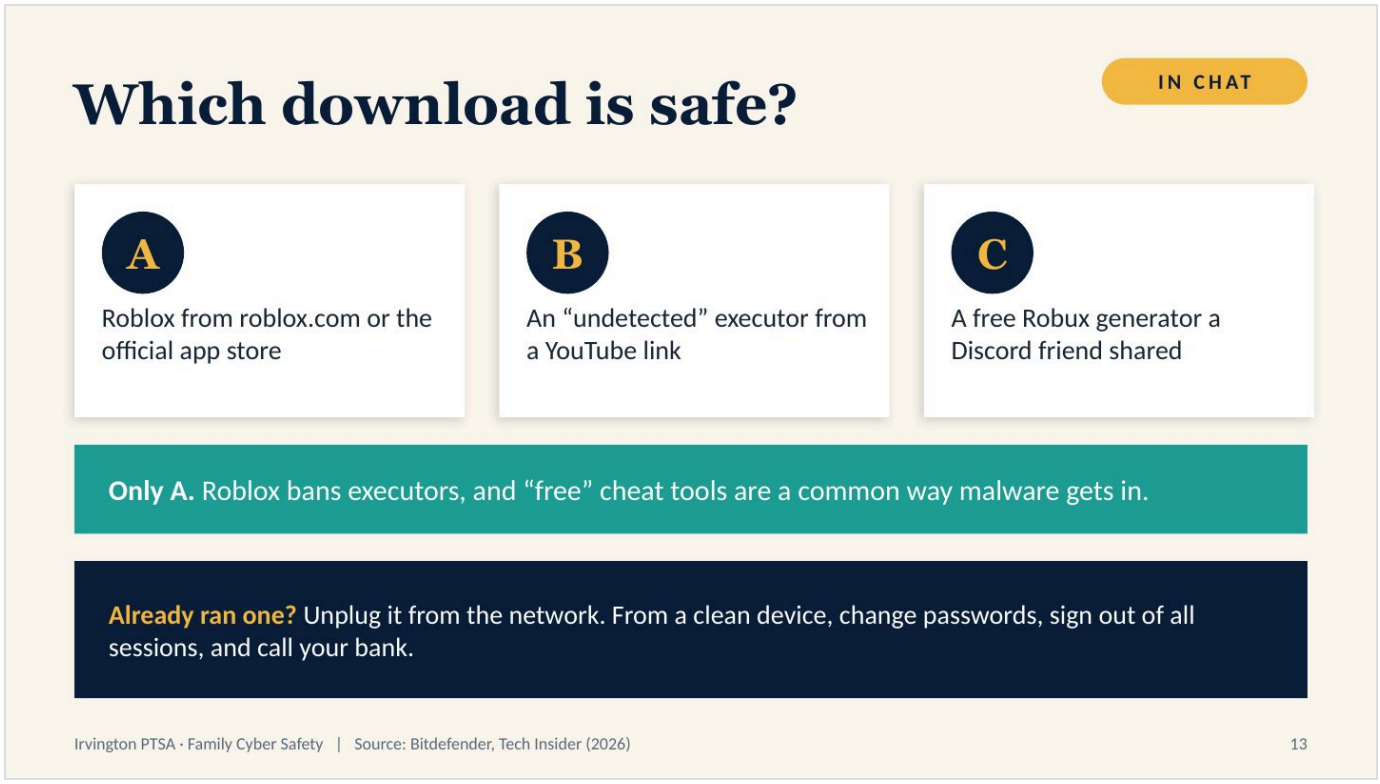
The centerpiece. No tech needed, free, five minutes; works for voice clones, spoofed numbers and “I’m at school, send someone to pick me up” texts. Give everyone two minutes to type in the chat how they would introduce it to a teen (or use breakout rooms if enabled), then read out a few (“a safety game, not a trust issue”). Bad words: pet names, street or school names, birthdays, anything on Instagram or TikTok. Good: three random words or a silly inside joke never posted. Do not post your real word in the chat. Rotate it twice a year or if overheard.



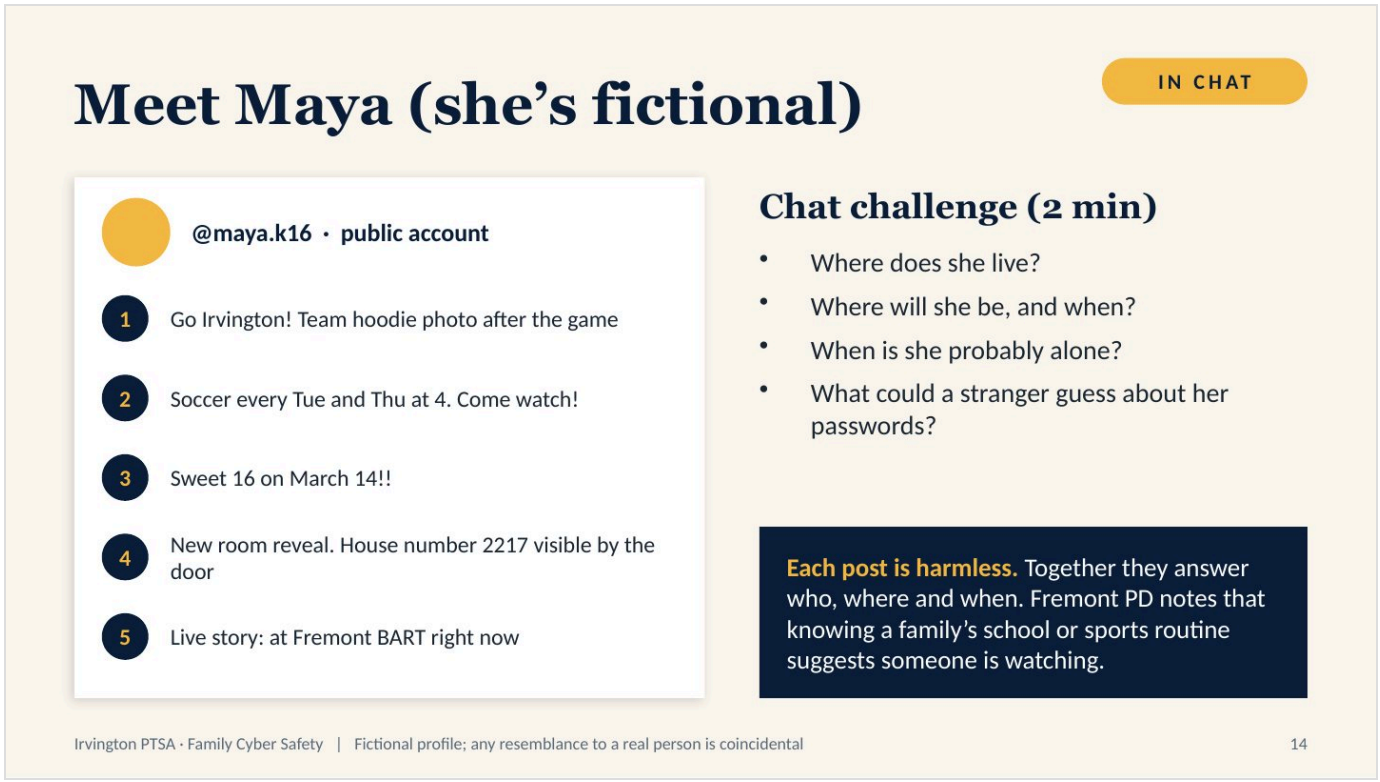
Read the three headlines aloud. Links: bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/fake-roblox-xeno-script-launcher-pushes-infostealer-rat-malware/ ; malwarebytes.com/blog/scams/2026/06/roblox-developers-are-losing-entire-games-to-malware-attacks ; techcrunch.com/2026/07/17/fbi-arrests-man-accused-of-using-steam-games-to-drain-victims-crypto-wallets/ ; bitdefender.com/en-us/blog/hotforsecurity/roblox-executors-parents-danger-malware (Oct 2025, updated Apr 2026). Be accurate: the Steam case is a different platform, shown to illustrate the same trick (a fun-looking download that drains crypto wallets).



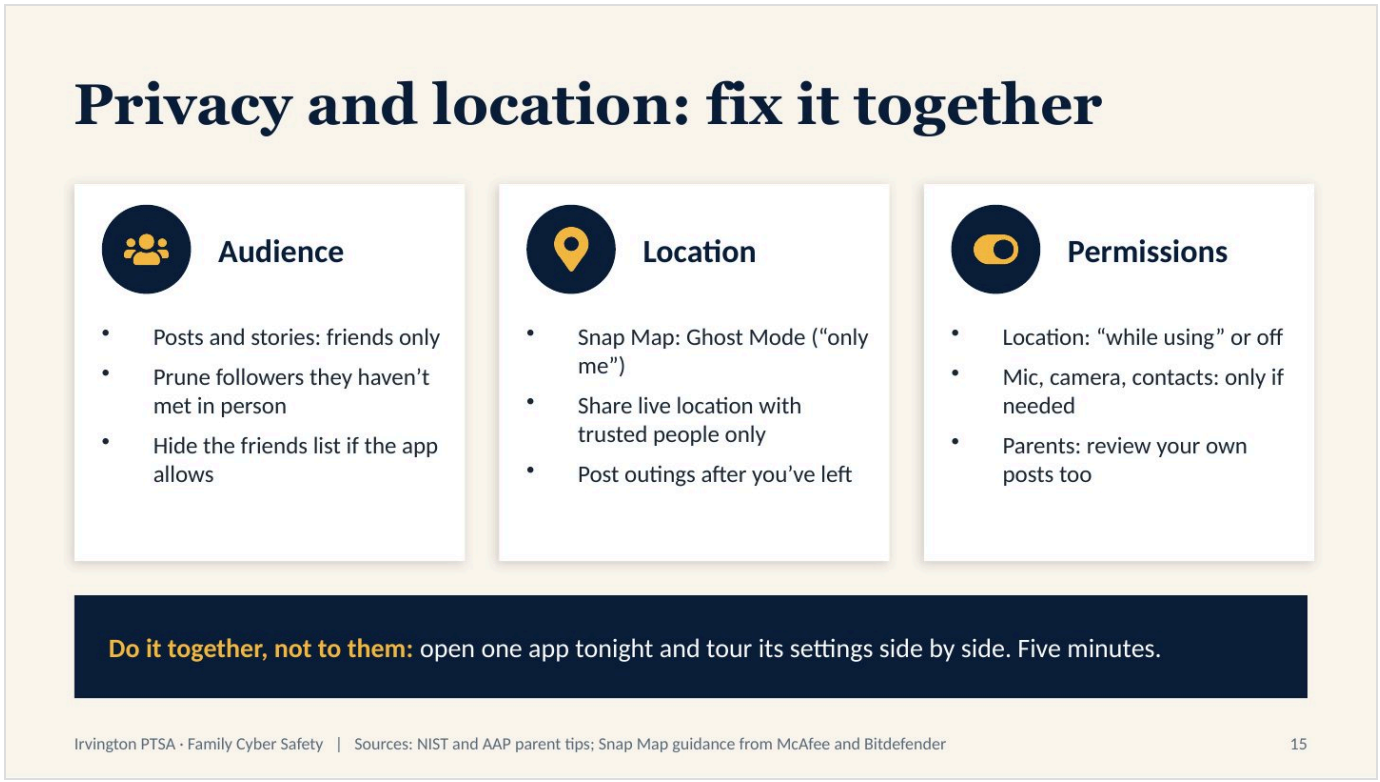
Walk the four steps with the story: a teen wants an edge in Roblox, runs a "free" tool, and the family computer, which is also logged into a parent's browser, is exposed. Accuracy: published reporting documents these tools stealing browser logins, cookies and payment data, and kids using parents' devices. Say exposed or at risk, not drained, unless you can cite a specific case. Keep it parent-friendly: this is not a Roblox-bashing slide; the official game is fine, the cheat tools are the problem.



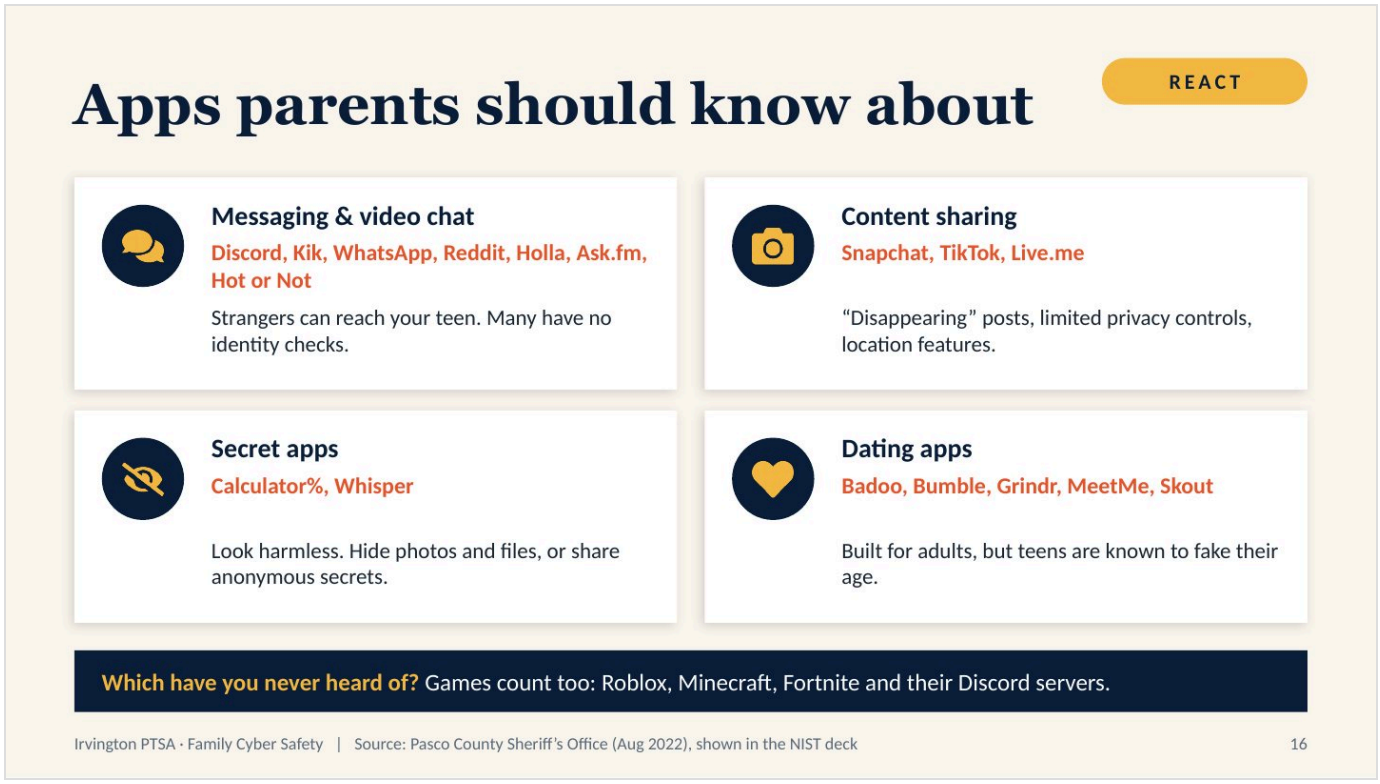
Vote in chat for A, B or C, then reveal. Then the "already happened" strip: treat the computer as compromised, rotate passwords from a different clean device, sign out of all sessions, enable 2-step login, watch statements, consider a credit freeze. Reassure: report it to the school/PTSA; no shame, because teens are targeted on purpose.



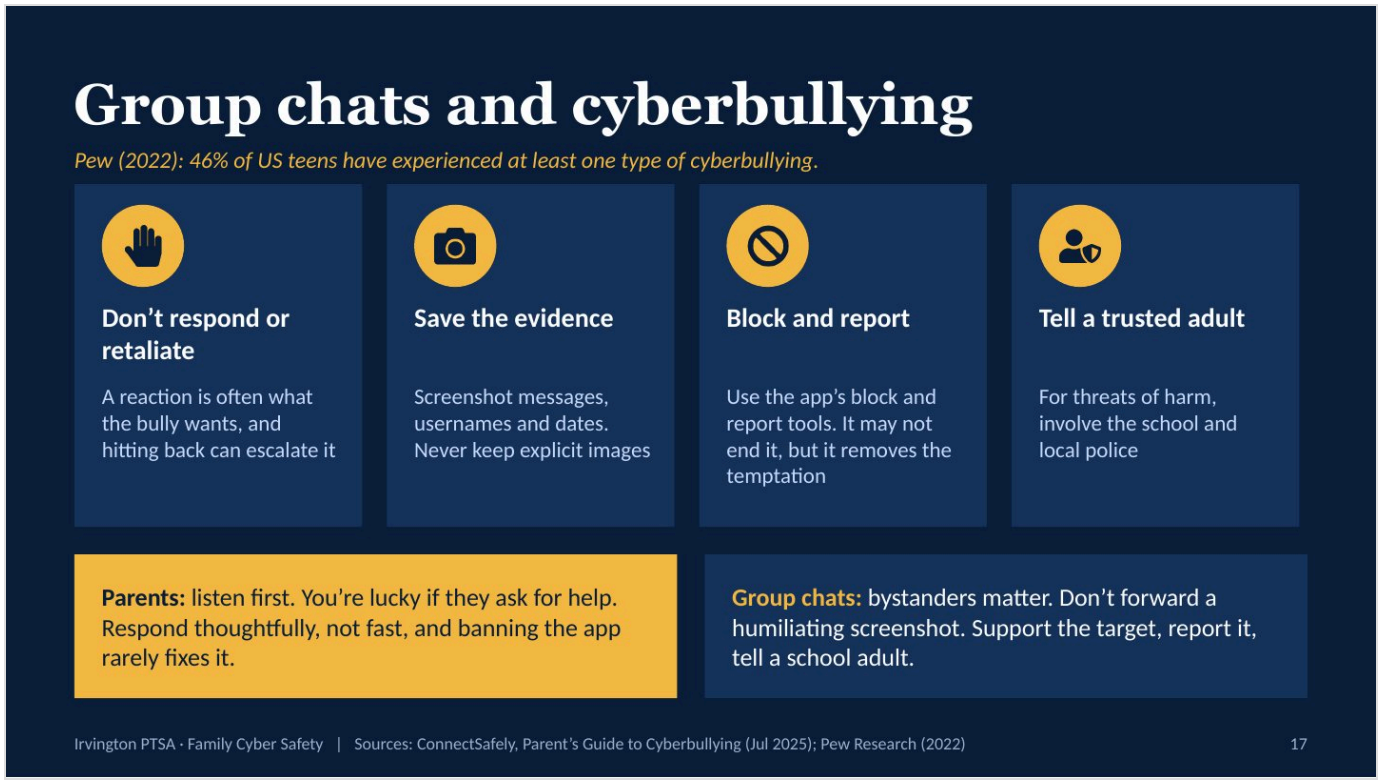
Give everyone two minutes to post clues in the chat, then reveal: (1) school affiliation in a public profile, (2) a fixed practice schedule = where she will be and when, (3) birthday = date of birth, handy for account recovery and social engineering, (4) a house number in a photo = home address, (5) a live story from a transit station = real-time location. Each post is harmless; together a stranger knows who, where and when. AAP advises limiting location-specific information and reviewing account privacy. Parents: review your own posts too. This is a made-up profile; no real student is depicted. Fremont PD (scams page): general details like a name and address are widely available, but specific routines such as a regular sports event would imply someone has been monitoring a person. Segue: now the settings that fix it.



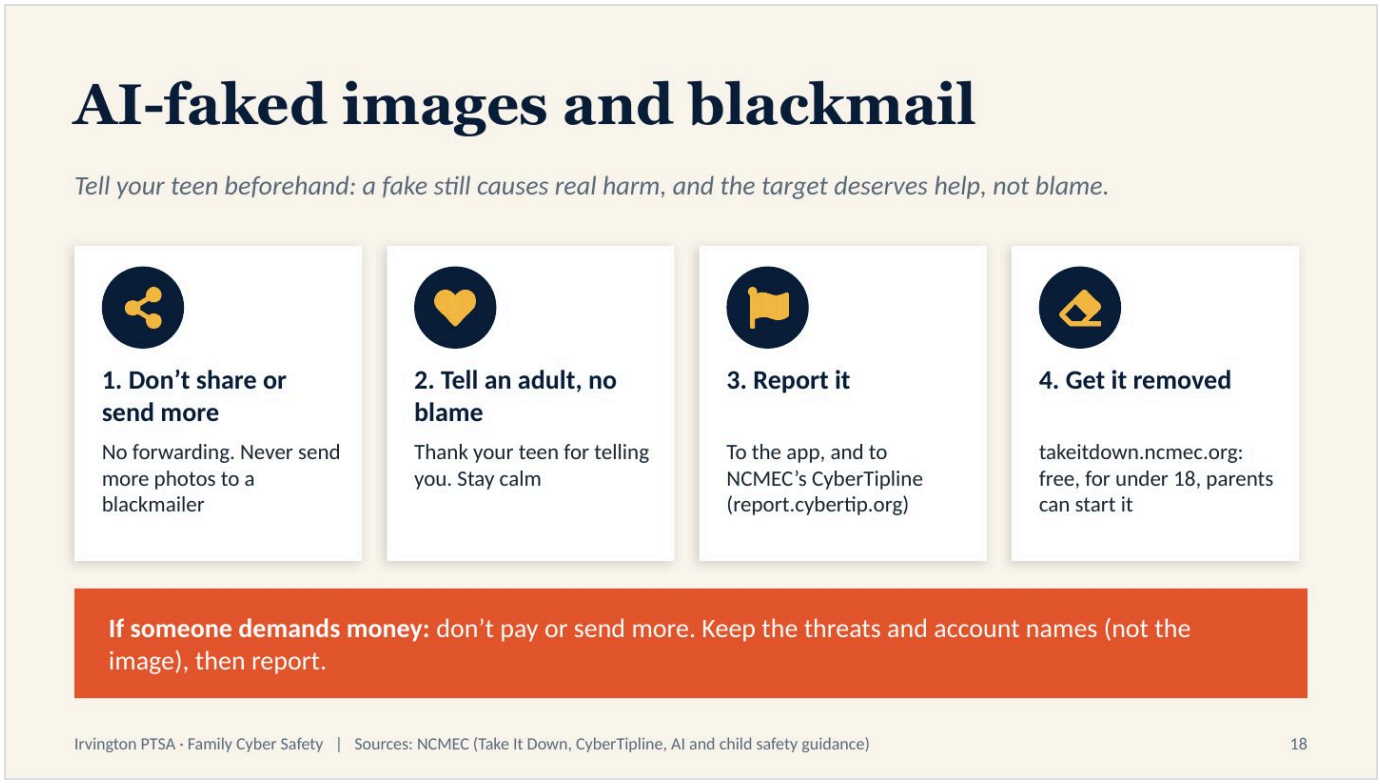
NIST tip: help kids own their online presence by setting privacy settings to your comfort level together, and remind them it is OK to limit how and with whom they share. AAP: check privacy settings before using new apps. Snap Map: three audiences (all friends, select friends, only me = Ghost Mode); it updates whenever the app is open, so it is not only when posting. Teens may feel social pressure when their Bitmoji disappears, so talk through it rather than just ordering it. Turning off phone location services is an extra step; also check app-level permissions. Settings change often; test on your own phone before presenting.



The list and categories are from the NIST deck (slide 29), which credits the Pasco County Sheriff's Office, August 2022. The list ages quickly: Omegle appears on the original list but shut down in 2023, so it is left off here. The Games line is an addition and is not on the NIST list. Ask for Zoom reactions: "which of these have you never heard of?". Message: you do not need to ban these; know which ones your teen uses and what the privacy settings are. Refresh with ConnectSafely before the event.



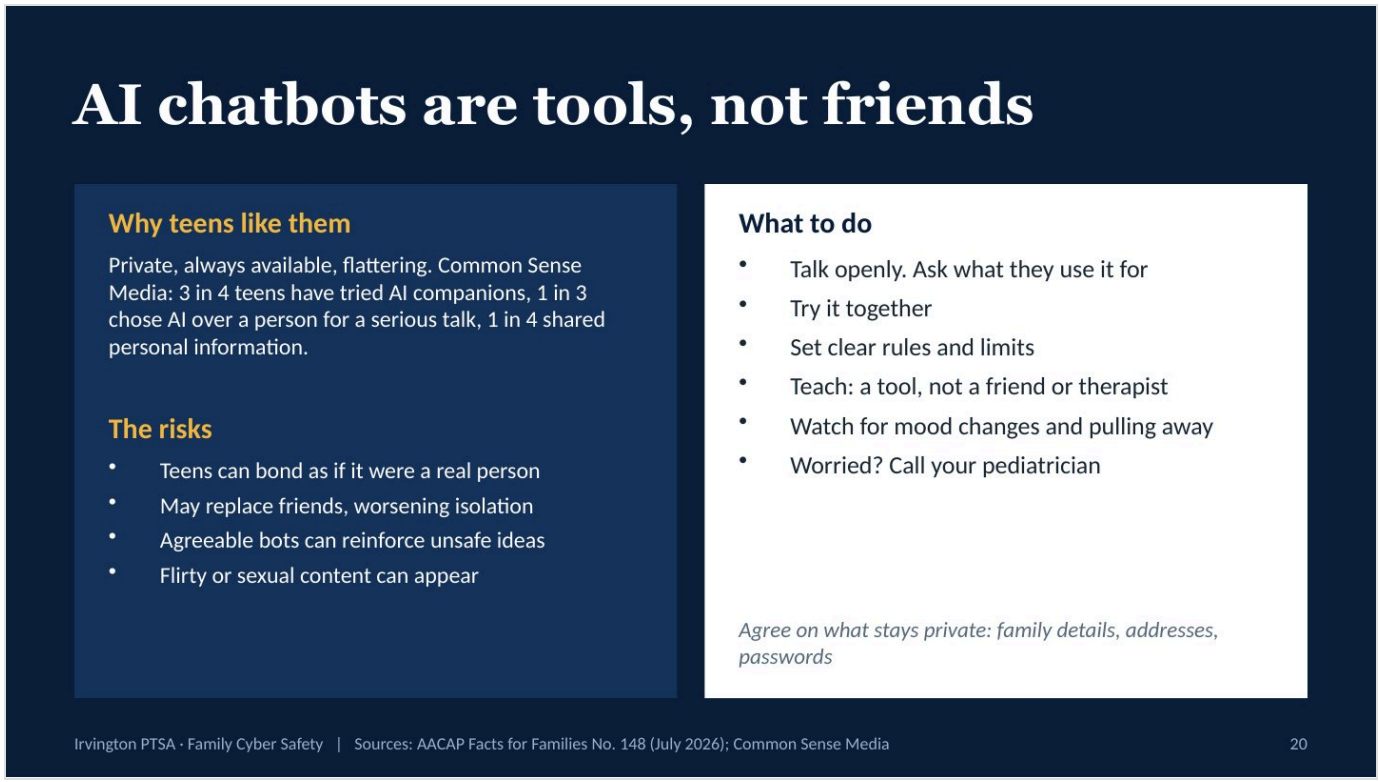
Verified against ConnectSafely's Parent's Guide to Cyberbullying (updated Jul 26, 2025). Steps for teens: it is not your fault; do not respond or retaliate (retaliating can turn one mean act into a chain reaction); save the evidence; block and report (it probably will not end it, but you will be less tempted to respond); get help; for threats of physical harm call local police with a parent and report to the school; if you see it, do not pass along a mean message. Parent points: you are lucky if your child asks for help, since most do not tell; respond thoughtfully, not fast, because acting publicly can worsen the marginalization; what victims say helps most is being truly listened to; solutions matter more than punishment; banning an app or taking the phone does not solve it, because the interaction continues and a ban can leave the teen left out. Kids may call it drama, so avoid leading with the word cyberbullying. Numbers on ConnectSafely's page: Pew 2022 found 46% of US teens had experienced at least one type of cyberbullying (name-calling 32%, false rumors 22%, unwanted explicit images 17%, explicit images shared without consent 7%); NCES found about 19% of students 12 to 18 were bullied in 2021-22, and 22% of those say it happened online or by text. The group-chat line (leave, do not forward) is a practical addition; ConnectSafely advises not passing along mean messages. Also see connectsafely.org/Sextortion/.



Sensitive topic: keep your tone calm and matter-of-fact, no graphic detail. From NCMEC's generative AI page: offenders may create an explicit AI image of a child who refused to send a nude, then use it to blackmail the child for more content. NCMEC says report to the CyberTipline (report.cybertip.org), request removal through Take It Down (takeitdown.ncmec.org; anonymous removal requests from participating platforms), and report the content to the platform. NCMEC also offers support: its 24-hour call center is 1-800-843-5678. Do not pay or send more, and keep threats and account details but not the explicit image, are widely given safety guidance rather than NCMEC page text, so present them as general advice. The federal TAKE IT DOWN Act requires platforms to offer removal processes for nonconsensual intimate images; keep claims about its scope general. Resource: connectsafely.org/Sextortion/.



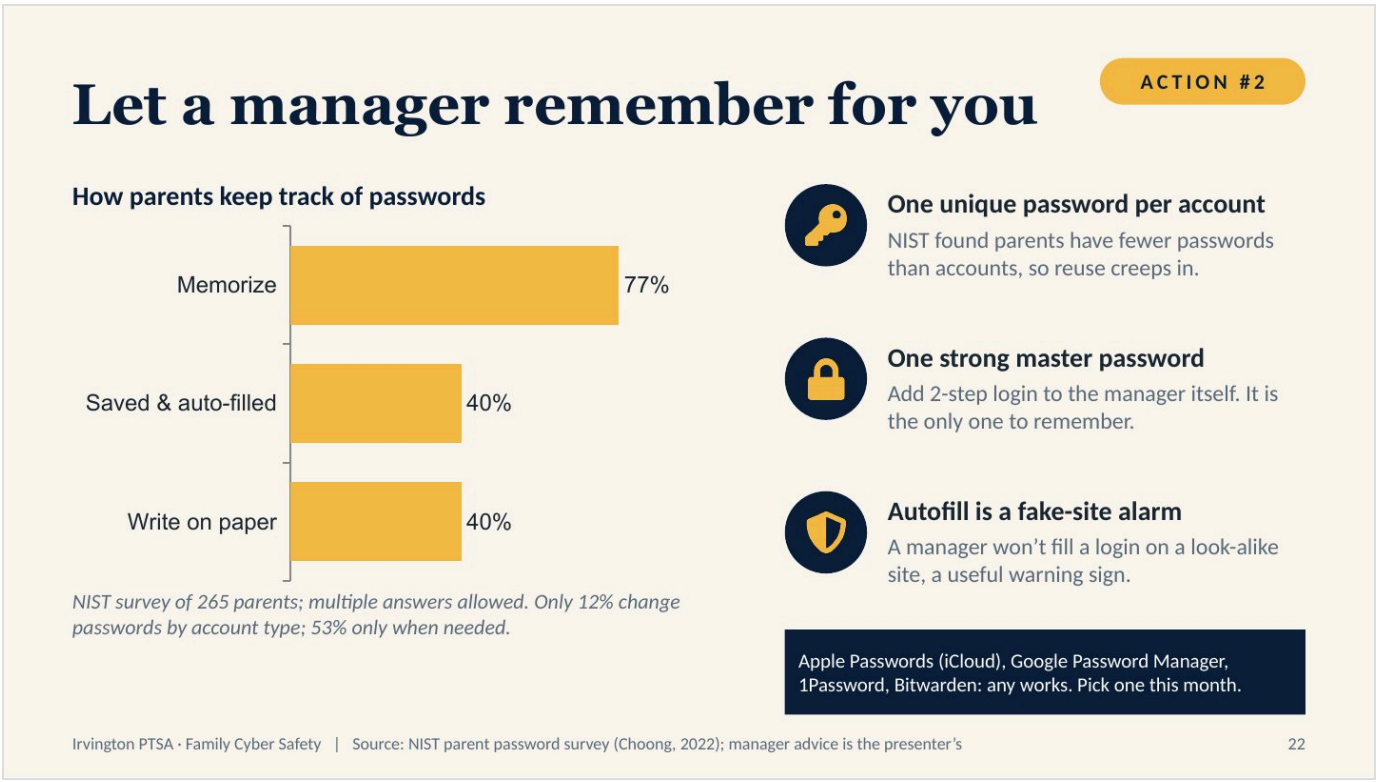
Quick vote in chat. Reveal B. Point: your response determines whether your teen tells you next time.



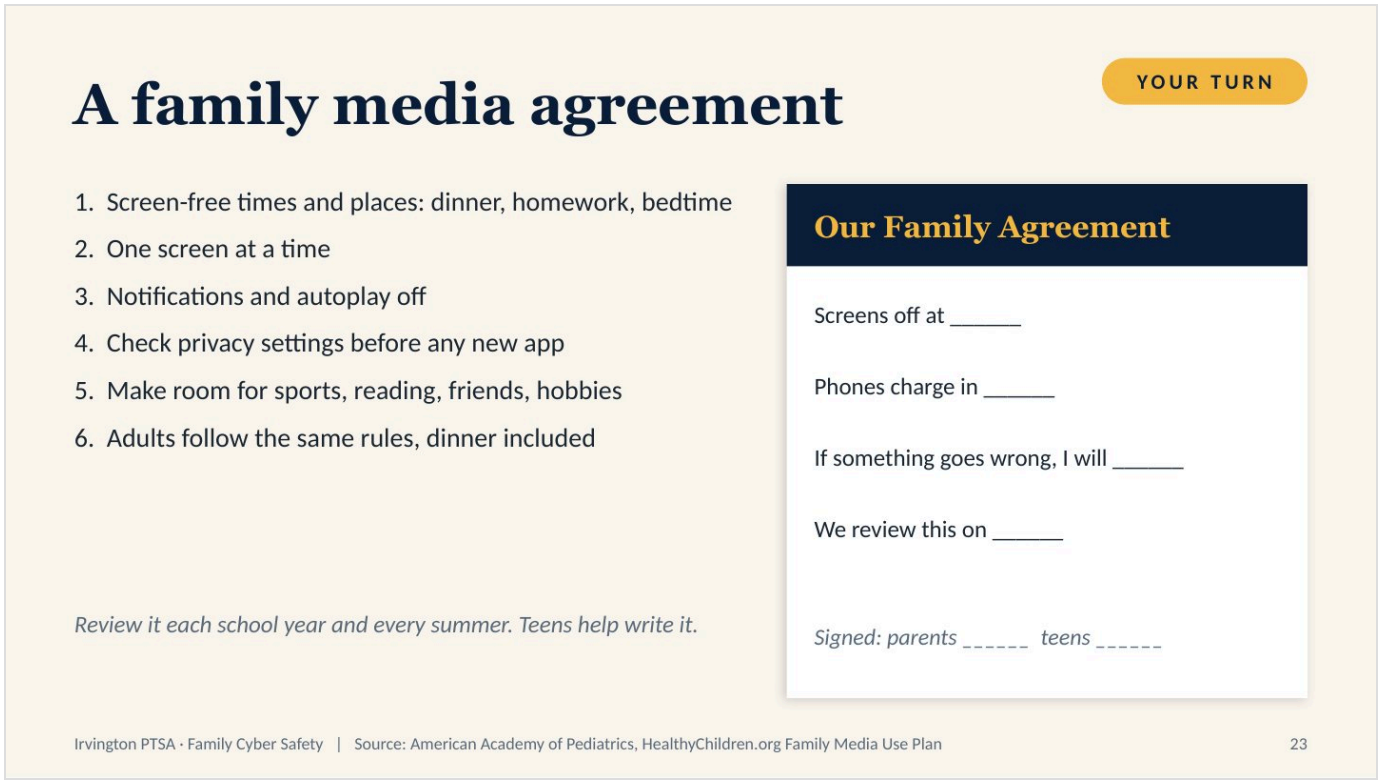
Follows AACAP's Facts for Families guide: companions are programs that respond like a helpful friend; appeal is privacy, availability, agreeable and complimentary replies; risks include strong emotional bonds, isolation, reduced social-skills practice, flirtatious or sexual content, and reinforcing unhealthy ideas; AACAP says companions are not considered safe for children and parents should strongly consider restricting or removing access. Model moderate screen use. Be careful to distinguish homework helpers from companion apps. AACAP does not list specific warning signs; the mood and withdrawal items are its general concerns. Common Sense Media research (Talk, Trust, and Trade-Offs): nearly 3 in 4 teens have used AI companions and half use them regularly; about a third have chosen an AI over a person for a serious conversation; about a quarter have shared personal information; its position is that no one under 18 should use these platforms. Ask: "who has heard your teen talk to a chatbot like a friend?"



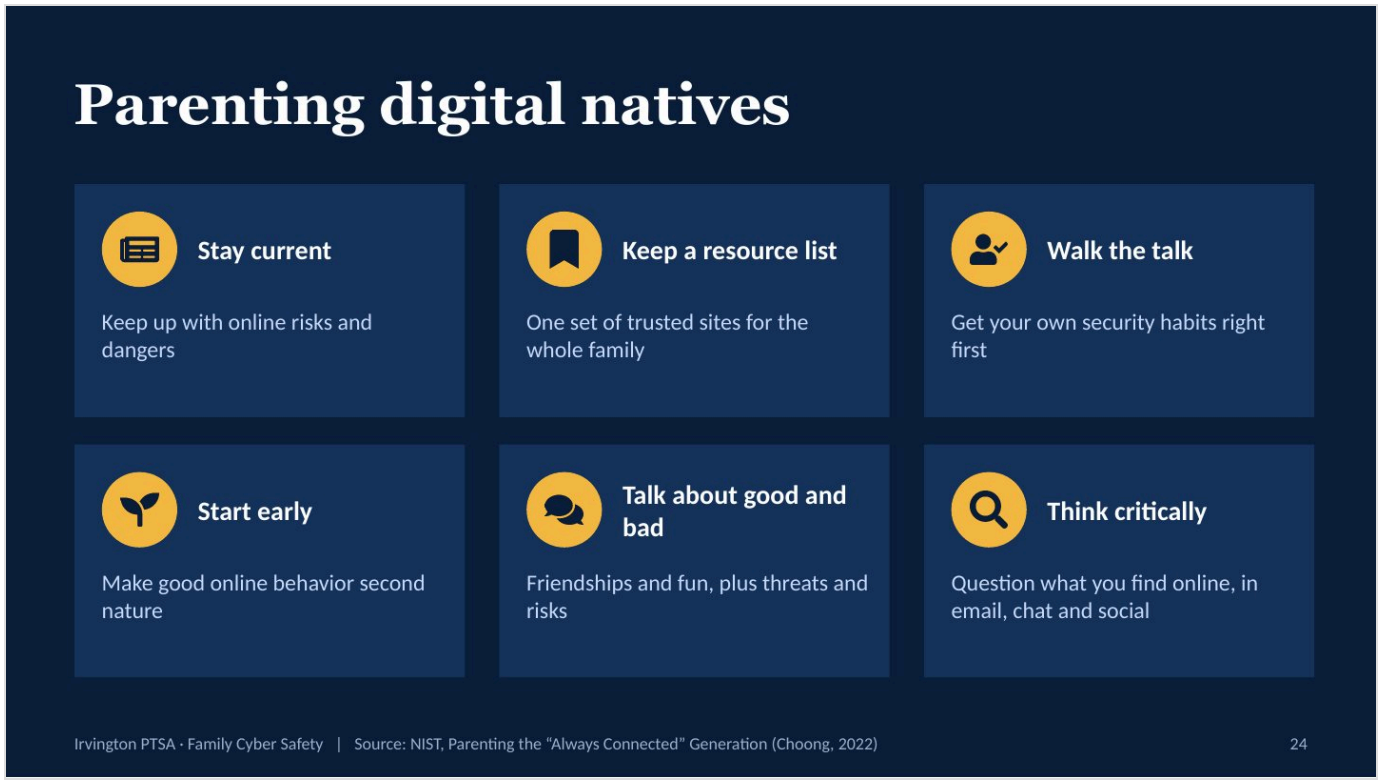
AAP recommends using parental controls for screen time, downloads, contacts and purchases on routers, phones, tablets, consoles, social media accounts and school devices, and turning off autoplay and notifications. Bitdefender (Roblox executors guide): standard accounts without admin rights for kids, updates, real-time antivirus, 2-step login on Roblox, email and payment accounts. NIST: your home is not the only place kids go online, so settings alone are not enough. Chatbot controls: they vary widely; some provide parental settings, many have none. Product controls change often, so check them on your own phone before demonstrating. Password managers are the next slide.



This is action 2 of the seven (protect accounts, keep login codes private). The NIST deck has no password-manager slide; the data is NIST's parent password survey: 77% memorize, 40% write on paper, 40% saved and auto-filled, 53% change only when needed. Name the options without endorsing one: Apple Passwords (iCloud Keychain) if the family is on iPhone, Google Password Manager (in Chrome and Android), and dedicated apps such as 1Password or Bitwarden that work across devices; several offer family plans or shared groups for shared logins like streaming or Wi-Fi. The recommendation itself is general best practice, not NIST's. Demo idea: show the autofill prompt on your phone, and note it will not fill on a look-alike site. Remind parents to protect the manager with a strong master password and 2-step login. Kids: younger children rely on family to create and remember passwords, so set it up together; teens can run their own.



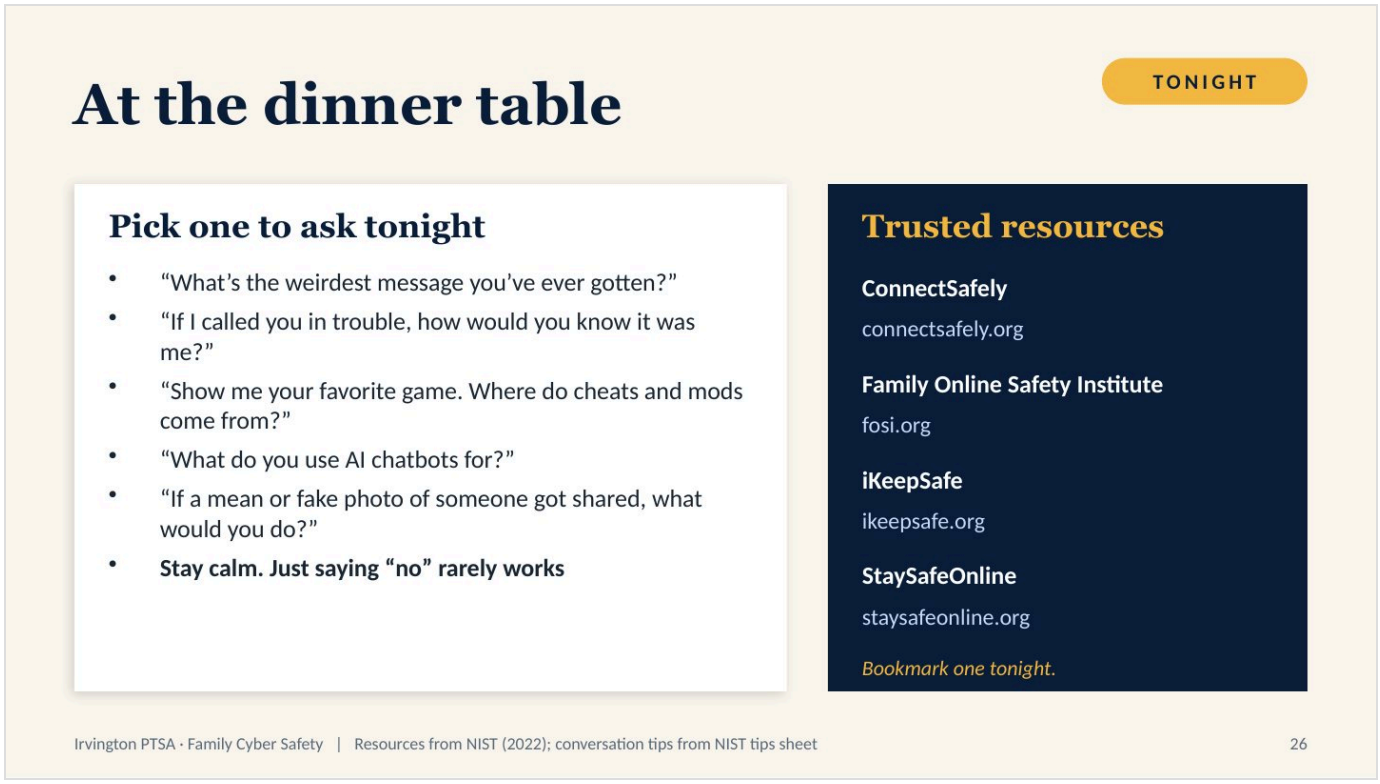
The six items come from AAP's "How to Make a Family Media Use Plan": screen-free times and places, one screen at a time, turn off autoplay and notifications, check privacy settings, make room for other activities, model healthy habits yourself. AAP: every family is different; discuss the rules with your kids; include a plan for every family member including parents; review at the start of the school year or on summer and holiday breaks. AAP has little teen-specific guidance on this page; involving teens in writing the rules is the key teen point. The sample fill-in card is the presenter's idea. Suggest a free printable from healthychildren.org (search "Family Media Plan").



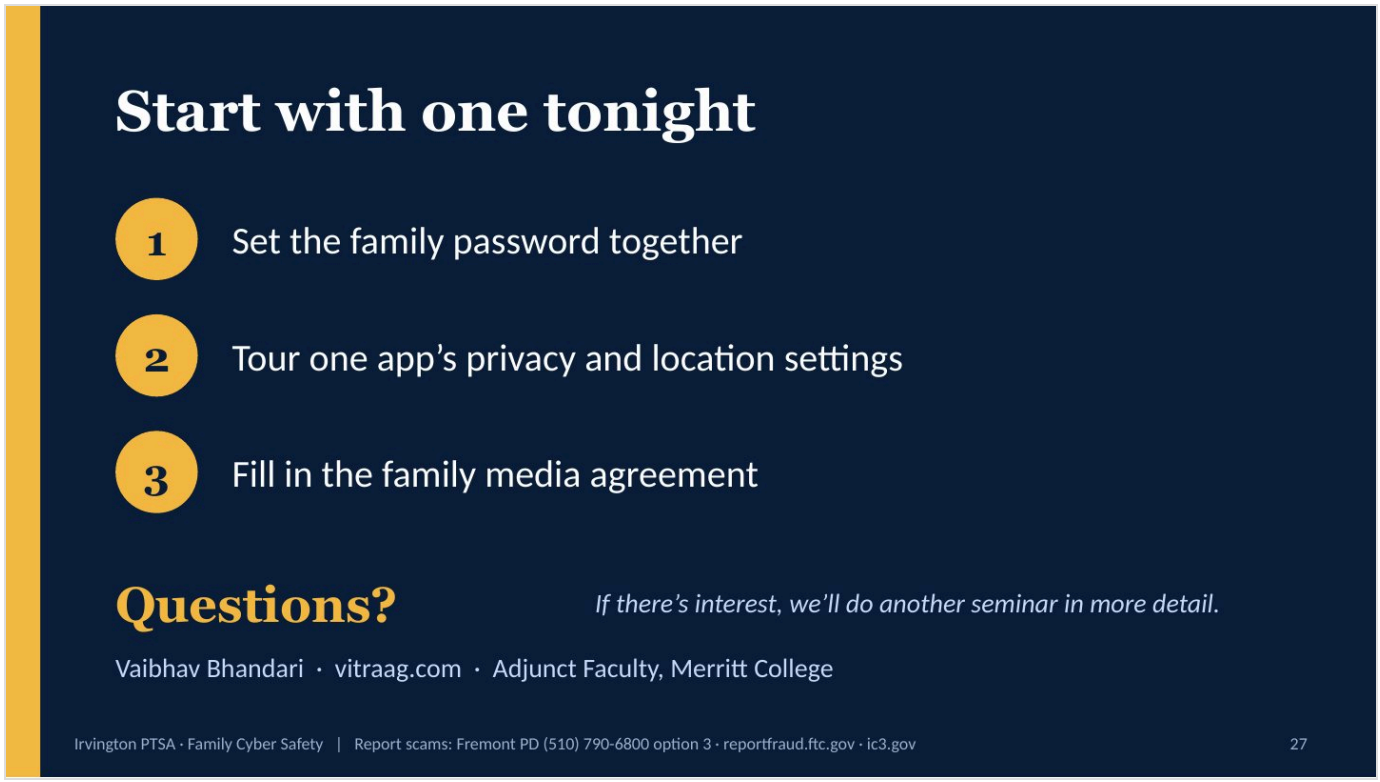
These six points are NIST's "Parenting Digital Natives" slides (27-28). Also from NIST's "Youth Cybersecurity and Privacy Education" slide: reinforce good perceptions early (kids' understanding of passwords is reasonably accurate), promote concrete understanding (kids describe why passwords matter only vaguely), and bridge the gap between knowledge and behavior (e.g., sharing passwords with friends). Make the "walk the talk" point lightly: NIST found parents reuse passwords too.



Walk the seven quickly (about 10 seconds each), tying each to something from tonight: 1 = family password and voice clones; 2 = password manager, 2-step login, never read out a login code; 3 = fake jobs, giveaways and free cheats; 4 = the Maya exercise; 5 = group chat and AI-image slides; 6 = chatbots and the media agreement; 7 = "you won't be in trouble for telling me", with a plan: who to call, what to screenshot, how to report. Then give 60 seconds: each parent types the number of the ONE action they will do tonight in the chat. Ask people to type the number in chat.



Give parents 30 seconds to type in the chat the one question they will ask this week. Conversation tips draw on NIST's Internet Safety and Security Tips for Parents: remain positively engaged, just saying no rarely works, make it a teachable moment, support good choices as they show competence. ConnectSafely adds: listen first, and it is a good sign if your teen asks for help. The four resources are from the last slide of the NIST deck; NIST suggests keeping a ready collection of reputable resources for the family.



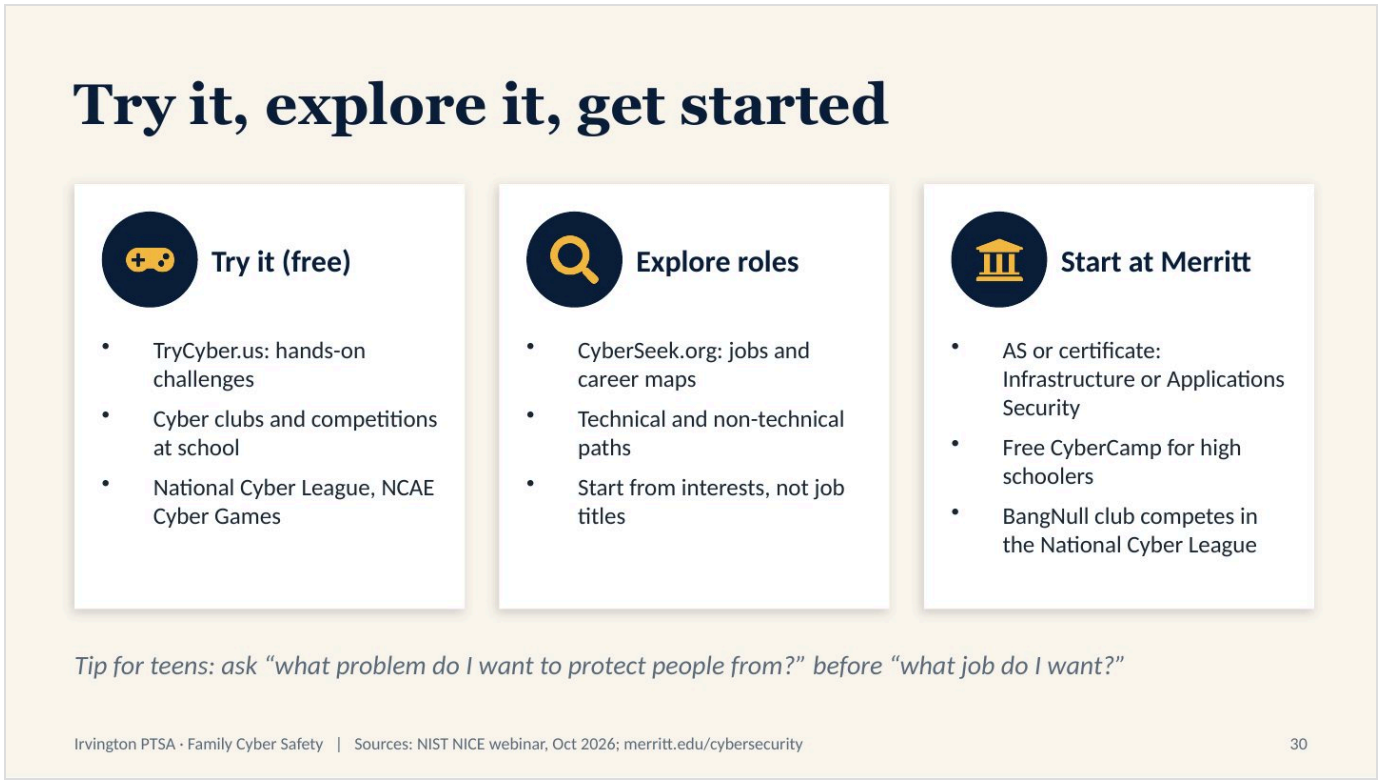
Land the three actions, then take questions. If time is short, end here and hang around afterwards for questions.



Backup section: the bonus careers side note. Use it if there is time or interest.



Keep this light. Tie back: the skills tonight (skepticism, verifying, protecting people) are the same skills of a cyber career. 500,000+ figure is from the NICE webinar deck citing CyberSeek/CompTIA 2025. As an adjunct at Merritt, share one line on the students you see.



Keep it light. TryCyber, CyberSeek, National Cyber League and NCAE Cyber Games are from the NICE webinar deck. Merritt details are from merritt.edu/cybersecurity: AS degrees and Certificates of Achievement in Infrastructure Security and in Applications Security (AS about two years, classes on Fridays, with internships and labs); CyberCamp is a free two-week introductory course for middle schoolers, high schoolers and adults; the BangNull Cybersecurity Club, founded in 2014, competes in the National Cyber League; Merritt students placed in the top 2.8% in the Spring 2025 National Cyber League rankings; the program holds an annual Cybersecurity Career Day. Merritt is in Oakland (12500 Campus Drive). CyberCamp dates and eligibility are on the Merritt page; check them before promising anything to families.

Announcement: Techs on Decks

Nov 14, 2026 · 10 AM – 5 PM
USS Hornet Sea, Air & Space Museum

- **Free for students and educators with ID.**
- Hands-on STEM: compass navigation, robotics, skyscraper construction, live demos.
- Early registrants get 1-hour docent-led tours: Flight Deck, Engine Room, Power Generation, Navigation, Combat Information Center.
- Free pizza from Domino's.
- Sponsored by the Community of Information Systems Executives (CISE).

Register with the QR code on the flyer. Great for teens curious about tech.



Quick announcement, not part of the cyber safety content. Techs on Decks is a free, hands-on STEM day aboard the USS Hornet on Nov 14, 10 AM to 5 PM, for students and educators with ID. Early registrants can book 1-hour docent-led tours. Registration is through the QR code on the flyer. Good for any teen curious about technology.